

Manit Baser

PhD student, National University of Singapore

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EDUCATION

National University of Singapore, Singapore

01/2024 - 12/2027 (Expected)

Ph.D. in Electrical and Computer Engineering | GPA: 4.28/5.0

Advisors: Mohan Gurusamy, Dinil Mon Divakaran

Birla Institute of Technology and Science (BITS) Pilani, Pilani, India

08/2017 - 05/2021

Bachelor of Engineering in Electrical and Electronics | GPA: 8.39/10.0

EXPERIENCE

A*STAR Institute of Advanced Intelligence and Computing (A*STAR IAIC)

02/2026 - Present

Research Intern, Singapore

National University of Singapore

08/2023 - 01/2024

Research Assistant, Singapore

Microsoft

06/2022 - 08/2023

Software Engineer, Bangalore, India

Flipkart

06/2021 - 06/2022

Software Engineer, Bangalore, India

Draup

07/2020 - 12/2020

Software Engineering Intern, Bangalore, India

Sun Mobility

05/2019 - 08/2019

Software Engineering Intern, Bangalore, India

PUBLICATIONS

- [1] **Relevance as a Vulnerability: How Web Retrieval Degrades Safety Alignment in LLM Agents**
Aditya Nawal, Manit Baser, Mohan Gurusamy [PDF]
Findings of the Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing 2026 EMNLP 2026
- [2] **CLaRE-ty Amid Chaos: Quantifying Representational Entanglement to Predict Ripple Effects in LLM Editing**
Manit Baser, Alperen Yildiz, Dinil Mon Divakaran, Mohan Gurusamy [PDF]
Findings of the Association for Computational Linguistics 2026 ACL 2026
- [3] **ThinkEval: Practical Evaluation of Knowledge Leakage in LLM Editing using Thought-based KGs**
Manit Baser, Dinil Mon Divakaran, Mohan Gurusamy [PDF]
Transactions on Machine Learning Research 2026 TMLR 2026
- [4] **In Tokens We Trust: Exposing Superficial Editing and Unlearning with Adversarial Tokenization**
Manit Baser, Aditya Nawal, Dinil Mon Divakaran, Mohan Gurusamy
Under submission
- [5] **DarKnight: Retrieval-Guided Agentic Framework for Breaking Dark Web CAPTCHA Gates**
Binghui Wu, Yeo Zi Yi, Darren Tan Peng Quan, Manit Baser, Levente Csikor, Dinil Mon Divakaran
Under submission
- [6] **Step-by-Step Reasoning Attack: Revealing 'Erased' Knowledge in Large Language Models**
Yash Sinha, Manit Baser, Murari Mandal, Dinil Mon Divakaran, Mohan Kankanhalli [PDF]
Preprint arXiv 2025

[7] **Three-Tier Indirect Tracing Model for Enhancing Epidemic Surveillance**

Gaurang Bansal, Mani Baser, Vinay Chamola [\[PDF\]](#)

IEEE Internet of Things Magazine 2024

IEEE IoTM 2024

AWARDS AND HONORS

- ▷ **NUS Research Scholarship, 2024** - Awarded a fully-funded PhD scholarship.
- ▷ **Cisco-NUS Accelerated Digital Economy Corporate Laboratory Grant, 2023** - Appointed as Research Assistant on the project 'Anomaly Detection in Software Defined Networks'.
- ▷ **Full CS Dept. Fellowship, University of Pittsburgh, 2023** - Awarded a fully-funded PhD fellowship.
- ▷ **PhD Scholarship, University of Minnesota CS&E, 2023** - Awarded a fully-funded PhD fellowship.
- ▷ **Global Challenge Runner-Up | Microsoft Global Hackathon, 2022** - Secured second place in the "Hack for Microsoft Cloud" track among 12,000+ contestants; won \$2,000.
- ▷ **National 2nd Runner-Up | AB InBev Maverick 2.0 Botathon, 2021** - Developed a multilingual IVR chatbot with TTS & STT; third in the Grand Finale among 500+ teams; won Rs 30,000.
- ▷ **National Finalist | AB InBev Maverick 2.0 Hackathon, 2021** - Developed a cross-sell/up-sell recommender system for higher revenue generation.
- ▷ **Global Runner-Up | #EUvsVirus | European Commission, 2020** - Secured second in the Real-time Communication & Prevention track among 9,000+ participants; won £1,000.
- ▷ **National Finalist | Flipkart GRiD, 2020** - Primary speaker voice extraction from noisy audio; earned a pre-placement interview at Flipkart among 25,000 participants.
- ▷ **The Wolfram Award | COVID19 Hack Challenge, 2020** - Developed Covifight, a three-tier contact tracing solution; won a one-year Wolfram Alpha Pro subscription worth \$1875.

ACADEMIC SERVICE

- ▷ **Reviewer** Nature 2026, AAAI 2026, ACM TAIAP 2026
- ▷ **Volunteer** ACL 2026, CDE 2025 graduate admissions
- ▷ **Research Mentor** A list of students I have mentored:
 1. **Yeo Zi Yi** (NUS Computer Science) - Final-Year Project (FYP) Jan 2026 - May 2026
 2. **Darren Tan** (NUS Data Science and Analytics) - Final-Year Project (FYP) Jan 2026 - May 2026
 3. **Rachel Yeo** (NUS Computer Science) - Final-Year Project (FYP) Aug 2026 - May 2027
 4. **Vyoman Jain** (SUTD AI) - Master's student Aug 2026 - Dec 2026

TEACHING AND LEADERSHIP

National University of Singapore

08/2024 - 12/2025

Teaching Assistant - Electrical and Computer Engineering, *Singapore*

- ▷ **Fall 2025:** EE4204 Computer Networks; EE4211 Data Science for the Internet of Things
- ▷ **Spring 2025:** EE4204 Computer Networks; EE5311 Differentiable and Probabilistic Computing; EE5021 Cloud based Services for Internet of Things
- ▷ **Fall 2024:** EE4204 Computer Networks; EE4211 Data Science for the Internet of Things

DataNest Ventures

03/2020 - 06/2020

Co-Founder, *Gurgaon, India*

- ▷ Raised \$1,000 in funding from The Meta Group (EU); received \$6,500 in AWS credits and \$1,875 in Wolfram Alpha Pro credits for project Covifight.
- ▷ Managed a team of 12; built hybrid mobile & web apps with Java, Python, Node.js, and Gremlin Graph DB. Increased Covid-19 contact tracing detection rate by 3× vs. the DP3T model.
- ▷ Met with 50+ pan-European public partners, academics, and VCs to discuss deployment.

Delhi Public School, Gurgaon

04/2016 - 03/2017

House Captain, Jamuna House, Student Council, *Gurgaon, India*

Delhi Public School, Gurgaon

04/2015 - 03/2016

Vice House Captain, Jamuna House, Student Council, *Gurgaon, India*